

Postmortem: EU edge errors during UCL match

Date: 2026-06-09 · Status: Resolved · Authors: Edge / Reliability on-call

Summary

During a high-traffic Champions League fixture, the EU edge CDN began returning elevated 5xx errors for static and API traffic in eu-west. A bad cache configuration pushed to the edge fleet caused a subset of nodes to fail origin fetches. Sportsbook and casino static assets were intermittently unavailable to EU players for roughly 55 minutes during peak.

Impact

Affected services: edge-cdn, sportsbook. Error rate on the EU edge peaked near 8% against a 2% SLO error budget. Jurisdictions affected: UKGC. No data loss; degraded availability for EU players only. Detected at 18:40 UTC, mitigated at 19:35 UTC.

Dashboard at time of incident

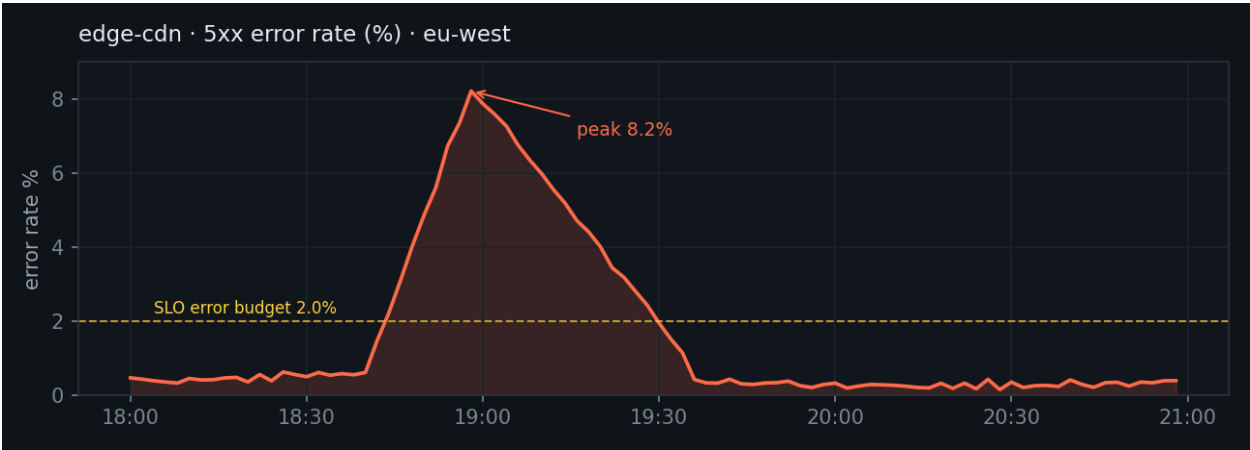


Figure: EU edge 5xx error rate. Healthy baseline ~0.4%; the spike begins at 18:40 and peaks around 18:58 before recovering after the rollback.

Timeline (UTC)

18:34	Edge cache config v220 rolled to EU fleet
18:40	5xx error-rate alert fires for eu-west; on-call paged
18:51	Bad config correlated with the 18:34 rollout
19:12	Rollback of v220 begins, node by node
19:35	Error rate back under SLO; incident closed

Root cause

Cache config v220 set an origin-fetch timeout below the origin's p99 response time for a subset of routes. Under match-peak load, those routes exceeded the timeout and the edge returned 5xx instead of serving stale or waiting. The config rolled fleet-wide without a canary stage.

Detection

Automated alert on EU edge 5xx error rate.

Action items

- Add a canary stage to edge config rollouts (1 node, then fleet) — owner: Platform-SRE — priority: high
- Set origin-fetch timeout from the origin p99, and serve-stale on timeout — owner: Platform-SRE — priority: high
- Add an edge config diff review to the deploy gate — owner: Platform-SRE — priority: medium

Notes

TTR ~55 min. This is the second edge-config rollout incident in eu-west this quarter; the missing canary stage is the recurring theme.